Aarhus university

Computer-Science

Numerical Linear Algebra

Handin 6

Author
Søren M. Damsgaard

Student number
202309814

March 23, 2026

Math done by a human

Consider the space of differentiable functions $f : [0, \pi] \to \mathbb{R}$ with the L^2 inner product

$$\langle f, g \rangle = \int_0^\pi f(x)g(x)\,dx. \tag{1}$$

Showing Orthogonality

For the given collection of functions defined on $x \in [0, \pi]$

$$\sin(x), \sin(2x), \ldots, \sin(kx), \quad \text{For every integer } k > 0 \tag{2}$$

Using equation(1) and applying the collection(2), it's possible to express the inner product of collection as such:

$$\int_0^\pi \sin(nx)\sin(mx)\,dx \quad \text{for } m \neq n \tag{3}$$

note the $m \neq n$ is used since $\langle f, f \rangle$ is the norm.
This integral can be made simpler by using the trigonometric identity 9.15 [1].

$$\int_0^\pi \frac{1}{2}[\cos((n-m)x) - \cos((n+m)x)]\,dx \quad \text{for } m \neq n$$

then using the integral rules, by taking the constants out and splitting the integral.

$$\frac{1}{2}[\int_0^\pi \cos((n-m)x)\,dx - \int_0^\pi \cos((n+m)x)\,dx] \tag{4}$$

from here each integral can be evaluated, starting with the first one.
Considering the first integral from equation(4), $\cos((n-m)x)$ can be seen as a composite function on the form $f(g(x))$, where $f(u) = \cos(u)$ and $g(x) = (n-m)x$.
This means the integral can be evaluated by substitution. Let $u = (n-m)x$ and $du = (n-m)dx$, then express dx.

$$du = (n-m)dx$$
$$dx = \frac{1}{(n-m)}du$$

Note the limits also change to accomodate u, this is done by putting the value of the limits into $g(x)$, which gives.

$$g(\pi) = (n-m)(\pi) = \pi(n-m)$$
$$g(0) = (n-m)(0) = 0$$

then substitute the above finding into the respective integral that was chosen.

$$\int_0^{\pi} \cos((n-m)x)\,dx \to \int_0^{\pi(n-m)} \cos(u)\frac{1}{(n-m)}\,du$$

remember to take the constant out:

$$\frac{1}{(n-m)}\int_0^{\pi(n-m)} \cos(u)\,du \tag{5}$$

now to integrate and evaluate (5).

$$\begin{aligned}
&\frac{1}{(n-m)}[\sin(u)]_0^{\pi(n-m)} \\
=&\frac{1}{(n-m)}(\sin((n-m)\pi) - \sin(0)) \\
=&\frac{1}{(n-m)}(0-0) \\
=&0
\end{aligned}$$

The reason for this is that $n, m \in k$ (integers) and $\sin(\pi) = 0$. Since any whole multiplier of π is either a half (odd number) or whole (even number) rotation which, in Mr.sin() eyes, is still 0.
It's assumed sin(0) needs no explanation.

With all that in order, the same can be shown for the second integral in equation(4) resulting in:

$$\frac{1}{2}[0-0] = 0$$

which means the inner product of the collection(2) is 0 meaning it's an orthogonal collection.

Constant function $f(x)$

Given the constant funnction $f(x) \equiv 1$, how does that change the orthogonality when k is 'even' or 'odd'?.
Inserting the new $f(x)$ in equation(1).

$$\langle f, g\rangle = \int_0^{\pi} 1 \cdot g(x)\,dx.$$

this prevents the use of trigonominal identities resultig in evaluating cos() instead of sin() in the integral.

By evaluating the integral via substitution, like in the previous integral.

$$\begin{aligned}
&\int_0^{k\pi} \sin(u)\frac{1}{k}\,du \\
&= \frac{1}{k}\int_0^{k\pi} \sin(u)\,du \\
&= \frac{1}{k}[-\cos(u)]_0^{k\pi} \\
&= \frac{1}{k}(-\cos(k\pi) - (-\cos(0)))
\end{aligned}$$

Here is the clutch, $-\cos(0) = -1$ and depending on how many π rotations, $-\cos(k\pi)$ is either 1 or -1. For an odd k $-\cos(k\pi) = 1$ and for even $-\cos(k\pi) = -1$, which changes the result in step (4) above to either 0 or some non-zero number $w \in [-1, 0)$
Note: The author knows the notation could be simplified, but it made more sense to be explicit in the moment of greatness.

Projection

Determinign the projection onto $\sin(x)$ and $\sin(3x)$ using $f(x) \equiv 1$ yiels:

$$proj_{\sin(x)}(1) = \frac{\int_0^{\pi} 1 \cdot \sin(x)\,dx}{\int_0^{\pi} \sin(x) \cdot \sin(x)\,dx} \tag{6}$$

$$proj_{\sin(3x)}(1) = \frac{\int_0^{\pi} 1 \cdot \sin(3x)\,dx}{\int_0^{\pi} \sin(3x) \cdot \sin(3x)\,dx} \tag{7}$$

Using the results from the previous section, the numerator in(6) and(7) can be generalized to $\frac{2}{k}$ since both $\sin(x)$ and $\sin(3x)$ use odd k values.
Before inserting anything the denominator shall be evaluated, starting with equation(6).

$$\int_0^{\pi} \sin(x) \cdot \sin(x)\,dx$$

The above integral can be simplified using the trigonometric identities 9.15 [1] but for $\alpha = \beta$ and $\alpha = x$

$$2\sin^2(x) = -\cos(2x) + \cos(0)$$

isolate $\sin^2(x)$ to fit the case, remember $\cos(0) = 1$

$$\sin^2(x) = \frac{1 - \cos(2x)}{2} \tag{8}$$

substituting that into the integral

$$\int_0^{\pi} \frac{1 - \cos(2x)}{2}$$

extracting the constant and evaluating gets the following

$$\frac{1}{2}[x - \sin(2x)]_0^\pi$$

when evaluated

$$\frac{1}{2}((\pi - 0) - (0 - 0)) = \frac{1}{2}\pi = \frac{\pi}{2}$$

It's important to note for this that the result from integrating equation(8) using either x, as was just done, or $3x$ would yield the same resutl $\frac{\pi}{2}$ since $\sin(2x)$ and $\sin(6x)$ both equal 0.

References

[1] Andrew Swan. *Numerisk Linær Algebra*. Institut for Matematik, Aarhus Universitet, 2025.